

I'll use the same exhaustive family-sweep standard as the fullest reference: common senses, fixed constructions, specialist domains, family extensions, and then a final semantic merge.

Word family: **roast / roasts / roasted / roasting / roaster**

Base word: roast

Past tense: roasted

Past participle: roasted

***-ing* form:** roasting

Major related forms:

* roasted

* roasting

* roaster

Useful compounds/extensions:

* roast beef

* roast chicken

* roast vegetables

* roast dinner

* Sunday roast

* pot roast

* dry-roast / dry-roasted

* spit-roast

* coffee roast

* light roast

* medium roast

* dark roast

* roast profile

* roast level

* roast date

* coffee roaster

* roasting pan

* roasting tray

* roasting tin

* roasting joint

* celebrity roast

* get roasted

* roasting hot

* ore roasting

* sulfide roasting

* roasting furnace

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

****Related participial adjectives:**** roasted, roasting

Your sentence:

> “Your letter has the smell of ****roasted coffee****...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****roasted**** means ****coffee beans that have been heated at high temperature so that they brown, develop aroma and flavour, and become suitable for brewing****.

****繁體中文：****

* ****烘焙過的****

* ****烘烤過的****

* specifically for coffee: ****烘焙咖啡 / 烘焙過的咖啡豆****

A natural translation is:

> “the smell of ****roasted coffee****”

「****烘焙咖啡****的香氣」

or more precisely:

「****咖啡豆烘焙後散發出的香氣****」

The word is literal here. The larger sentence is figurative because the ****letter**** metaphorically “has” that smell.

A. ROAST = COOK WITH DRY HEAT

1. ****roast = cook food by surrounding it with dry heat (烤 ; 烘烤) ****

This is the central culinary meaning.

Practice 1

> “Roast the vegetables for thirty minutes.”

「把蔬菜****烤****三十分鐘。」

Practice 2

> “They roasted a chicken for dinner.”

「他們晚餐**烤了一隻雞**。」

The key idea is:

> food is cooked using relatively dry heat, traditionally near fire and now commonly in an oven.

2. **roast meat = 烤肉**

> “The meat was slowly roasted.”

「肉被慢慢**烤熟**。」

Common:

- * roast beef
- * roast pork
- * roast lamb
- * roast chicken
- * roast turkey

3. **roast vegetables = 烤蔬菜**

Common:

- * roast potatoes
- * roast carrots
- * roast pumpkin
- * roast peppers

4. **roast nuts = 烘烤堅果**

> “Roast the almonds lightly.”

「把杏仁稍微**烘烤**一下。」

5. **roast seeds = 烘烤種子**

Examples:

- * pumpkin seeds
- * sesame seeds
- * sunflower seeds

B. ROAST OVER / ON A FIRE

6. **roast something over a fire = place it near/directly over heat until cooked (在火上烤) **

> “They roasted chestnuts over the fire.”

「他們在火上**烤栗子**。」

7. **roast on a spit = 串在烤叉上旋轉烘烤**

A traditional cooking method.

8. **spit-roast = use a rotating spit to roast food (轉叉烤) **

> “The meat was spit-roasted.”

「肉用**旋轉烤叉烘烤**。」

Spit-roast also has an adult slang sense referring to a sexual arrangement involving multiple people; that slang use is separate from the culinary meaning and is inappropriate in ordinary food contexts.

C. OVEN ROASTING

9. **roast in the oven = 在烤箱內烘烤**

> “Roast the potatoes in a hot oven.”

「把薯仔放進高溫烤箱**烘烤**。」

10. ****roasting temperature = 烘烤溫度****

Food/cooking term.

11. ****roasting time = 烘烤時間****

D. ROAST VS BAKE

This distinction is important.

****roast****

traditionally associated with:

- * meat
- * vegetables
- * nuts
- * coffee
- * dry heat and browning

****bake****

especially associated with:

- * bread
- * cakes
- * pastries
- * dough/batter

Modern ovens use similar heat mechanisms, so the distinction is often based more on ****food type and culinary convention**** than totally different physics.

You normally say:

- > roast a chicken
- > bake a cake

not:

- > *bake a chicken* in ordinary recipe wording, though technically possible in some usages.

E. ROAST VS GRILL / BROIL

roast

surrounded by dry heat, often in an oven.

grill

food cooks close to/directly over intense radiant heat.

broil — especially AmE

heat usually comes from above.

F. ROAST VS FRY

fry

cook in hot fat/oil.

roast

dry-heat cooking, although some oil may be used on the surface.

> roast potatoes

may contain oil, but they are not therefore simply “fried potatoes.”

G. ROAST VS TOAST

toast

brown the surface of something, especially:

- * bread
- * grains
- * nuts

roast

usually cooks/heats more thoroughly and can develop deeper flavour.

Compare:

> toast bread

> roast coffee beans.

For nuts, both verbs may occur depending on method/context.

H. ROAST = THE COOKED FOOD

12. **roast = piece/dish of meat cooked by roasting (烤肉) **

Practice 3

> “We had a roast for dinner.”

Depending on region/context:

「我們晚餐吃了**烤肉大餐**。」

13. **beef roast = 烤牛肉塊**

Especially AmE, **roast** can refer to a cut/joint of meat intended for roasting.

> “Buy a three-pound beef roast.”

「買一塊約三磅重的**烤牛肉用肉塊**。」

14. **roast beef = 烤牛肉**

Can refer to:

* the cooked dish;

* thinly sliced roast beef used in sandwiches.

I. ROAST DINNER

15. **roast dinner = 烤肉餐**

Especially BrE:

A meal centered around roasted meat with accompaniments such as:

- * roast potatoes

- * vegetables

- * gravy

depending on tradition.

16. **Sunday roast = 星期日烤肉餐**

A traditional British/Irish-style Sunday meal centered on roast meat and accompaniments.

J. ROASTING JOINT

17. **roasting joint = cut of meat intended for roasting (烤肉用大塊肉) **

Especially BrE.

> “a joint of beef for roasting”

K. ROASTING PAN / TIN / TRAY

18. **roasting pan = 烤盤**

A pan used for roasting meat/vegetables.

Regional terms include:

- * roasting tin

- * roasting tray

L. POT ROAST

19. **pot roast = 美式燉烤牛肉 / 鍋燉烤肉**

Despite the word **roast**, pot roast is commonly cooked slowly in a covered pot with liquid, so the method is closer to **braising** than ordinary dry roasting.

This is a lexicalized dish name, not a perfect description of technique.

M. DRY-ROAST

20. **dry-roast** = roast without added oil/fat (乾烤)

> “The spices are dry-roasted before grinding.”

「香料在研磨前先**乾烤**。」

21. **dry-roasted nuts** = 乾烤堅果

Common packaged-food term.

N. COFFEE — ROAST BEANS

22. **roast coffee beans** = 烘焙咖啡豆

This is the exact domain in your sentence.

Green coffee beans are heated so that chemical and physical changes produce:

- * colour
- * aroma
- * flavour
- * reduced moisture
- * structural changes

before brewing.

23. **coffee roasting** = 咖啡烘焙

The process of roasting green coffee beans.

24. **freshly roasted coffee = 新鮮烘焙的咖啡**

> “The café sells freshly roasted beans.”

「咖啡店出售**新鮮烘焙的咖啡豆**。」

O. COFFEE ROAST = DEGREE / STYLE OF ROASTING

25. **roast = degree/style to which coffee has been roasted (烘焙程度) **

A distinct noun use.

> “Which roast do you prefer?”

「你喜歡哪一種**烘焙程度**？」

26. **light roast = 淺焙**

Beans roasted to a relatively lighter degree.

Often retains more characteristics associated with the bean/origin, though flavour depends on many variables.

27. **medium roast = 中焙**

Intermediate roast level.

28. **dark roast = 深焙**

Beans roasted further/darker, generally producing stronger roast-derived flavours.

29. **medium-dark roast = 中深焙**

Common commercial descriptor.

P. ROAST LEVEL

30. **roast level = 烘焙程度**

General term describing how lightly or darkly coffee is roasted.

31. **roast degree = 烘焙度**

Technical/specialty-coffee term.

Q. ROAST PROFILE

32. **roast profile = time-temperature development pattern used during roasting (烘焙曲線 / 烘焙設定) **

Can include:

- * time
- * temperature
- * heat input
- * development stages

depending on roaster methodology.

This is different from simply:

> light vs dark roast.

33. **roast development = 烘焙發展**

Specialty-coffee term for development during roasting, especially after important thermal/physical milestones.

R. ROAST DATE

34. **roast date = coffee roasting date (烘焙日期) **

Often printed on specialty-coffee packaging.

Different from:

> best-before date.

S. COFFEE ROASTER

35. **roaster = machine used to roast coffee (咖啡烘焙機) **

> “The café installed a new coffee roaster.”

「咖啡店安裝了一部新的**咖啡烘焙機**。」

36. **roaster = person/company that roasts coffee (咖啡烘焙師 / 烘焙商) **

> “She's a specialty coffee roaster.”

Could mean:

* the person who roasts;

* the business/company doing the roasting.

Context determines.

37. **coffee roasting company / roastery**

A **roastery** is a place/business where coffee is roasted.

Related concept, though not a direct inflectional derivative.

T. FIRST CRACK / SECOND CRACK — COFFEE CONTEXT

These are established roast-process terms, though they belong primarily under **crack** rather than **roast**.

During coffee roasting, beans produce audible cracking sounds at stages conventionally called:

- * first crack
- * second crack

Roast development is often discussed relative to these events.

U. ROASTED FLAVOUR / ROAST CHARACTER

38. **roasted flavour = 烘烤風味**

Used for:

- * coffee
- * nuts
- * grains
- * vegetables
- * meats

Describes flavours generated through roasting.

39. **roasty / roast-like?**

Roasty does exist informally/technically in tasting vocabulary meaning having pronounced roast-derived flavours, but it is far less central than:

- > roasted
- > roast character
- > roast flavour.

For a learner database, mark **roasty** as low priority.

V. NOUN: A COMEDIC ROAST

Now a completely different modern branch.

40. **roast = event where a person is humorously insulted/teased publicly (吐槽 / 調侃大會)

**

Practice 4

> “They held a roast for the retiring manager.”

「他們為即將退休的經理舉辦了一場幽默**吐槽 / 調侃活動**。」

The target normally knows/accepts that joking insults are part of the format.

41. **celebrity roast = 名人吐槽大會**

A comedy format in which performers make deliberately harsh jokes about a central guest.

42. **roast master / roastmaster = 主持吐槽活動的人**

A host/lead performer at a roast.

Spelling varies.

W. VERB: ROAST SOMEONE

43. **roast someone = mock or criticize someone harshly, usually humorously (狠狠吐槽 ; 嘲諷) **

Practice 5

> “His friends roasted him for arriving late.”

「朋友因他遲到而狠狠**吐槽 / 取笑**他。」

This is now very common informal English.

44. **roast someone for something**

> “People roasted the company for the advertisement.”

「大家因那則廣告而狠狠**嘲諷**該公司。」

Pattern:

> ****roast someone for + reason****

45. ****get roasted = become the target of ridicule (被狠狠吐槽) ****

> “He posted the photo and immediately got roasted.”

「他一上載照片就立刻****被大家狠狠吐槽****。」

Very common online/social-media English.

46. ****roast battle = competitive insult-comedy event (吐槽對決) ****

Participants exchange prepared insulting jokes.

X. ROAST VS TEASE / MOCK / INSULT

****tease****

can be mild/playful.

****mock****

imitate or ridicule.

****insult****

say/do something offensive.

****roast****

typically means sustained, pointed ridicule, often humorous and sometimes consensual.

So:

> a roast can contain insults

but the comedic frame matters.

Y. ROAST VS CRITICIZE

criticize

can be serious, analytical, non-humorous.

roast

is informal and often humorous/exaggerated.

> “The reviewer criticized the film.”

neutral.

> “The internet roasted the film.”

means:

> widespread mocking/ridicule.

Z. **ROASTING** = EXTREME HEAT

47. **roasting = extremely hot (酷熱的) — informal, especially BrE**

> “It's roasting today.”

「今天**熱死了 / 非常炎熱**。」

48. **roasting hot = 熱得要命**

> “The room was roasting hot.”

「房間**熱得要命**。」

Informal.

49. **I'm roasting = 我熱死了**

Means:

> I feel extremely hot.

Not:

> someone is literally cooking me.

AA. **ROASTING** AS INTENSE CRITICISM

50. **a roasting** = severe criticism/scolding (嚴厲斥責)

Especially BrE/informal:

> “He got a roasting from the manager.”

「他被經理**狠狠訓斥了一頓**。」

This can be less humorous than the comedy **roast** branch.

51. **give someone a roasting** = 狠狠責罵某人

> “The coach gave the team a roasting after the match.”

「教練賽後把球隊**狠狠訓了一頓**。」

AB. ROAST = MAKE SOMEONE VERY HOT

52. **roast** = expose someone/something to uncomfortable heat (使熱得難受)

Hyperbolic/informal:

> “We were roasting in the car.”

「我們在車裏**熱得要命**。」

Often appears as:

> be roasting

rather than active:

> roast someone.

AC. METALLURGY / CHEMISTRY

A major specialist sense that should definitely be indexed.

53. **roast an ore = heat ore strongly in air/oxygen below melting point to cause chemical change (焙燒礦石) **

In extractive metallurgy:

> **roasting**

means heating ore, often sulfide ore, in the presence of air/oxygen to drive chemical reactions.

繁體中文：*焙燒**

54. **ore roasting = 礦石焙燒**

Purpose may include:

- * oxidation
- * removal of sulfur
- * conversion to forms easier to process

depending on ore/process.

55. **sulfide roasting = 硫化礦焙燒**

A classic metallurgical use.

Example schematic:

> metal sulfide → metal oxide + sulfur-containing gases

depending on mineral and process.

56. **oxidizing roast / oxidizing roasting = 氧化焙燒**

Roasting in an oxidizing environment.

57. **reduction roasting / reducing roast = 還原焙燒**

A roasting process under reducing conditions for specified metallurgical transformations.

58. **chloridizing roasting = 氯化焙燒**

Specialist hydrometallurgy/extractive metallurgy.

59. **sulfating roasting = 硫酸化焙燒**

Used to convert certain metal compounds into sulfate forms.

Highly specialist.

AD. ROASTING VS CALCINATION

Important metallurgy/chemistry distinction.

roasting

typically involves heating ore in the presence of air/oxygen or another reactive atmosphere.

calcination

typically involves thermal decomposition/heating with limited or absent air depending on the process, often to remove:

- * CO₂

- * water

- * volatile components

Classic simplification:

- > sulfide ores → often roasted

- > carbonate ores → often calcined

But real industrial processes can be more complex.

AE. INDUSTRIAL ROASTER

60. **roaster = furnace/equipment used for roasting ore/material (焙燒爐) **

In metallurgy:

> roaster

can mean the industrial furnace/reactor used for roasting.

AF. FOOD INDUSTRY ROASTER

61. **roaster = appliance/vessel used to roast food**

Can mean:

- * roasting oven

- * roasting pan/container

- * specialized roasting appliance

depending on context.

62. **electric roaster / roaster oven = 電烤爐 / 烤箱**

An electric countertop appliance used for roasting/cooking.

AG. ROASTER = ANIMAL/FOOD SIZE CATEGORY

63. **roaster chicken = chicken of a size/age suitable for roasting**

Especially North American food classification.

Contrast can include:

- * broiler/fryer

* roaster

depending on commercial terminology.

Low priority but genuine.

AH. FIXED / PRODUCTIVE EXPRESSIONS

64. **roast to perfection = 烤得恰到好处**

> “The vegetables were roasted to perfection.”

「蔬菜烤得**恰到好处**。」

65. **slow-roasted = 慢烤的**

> slow-roasted pork

「慢烤豬肉」

66. **oven-roasted = 烤箱烤製的**

67. **fire-roasted = 火烤的**

Common for:

* tomatoes

* peppers

* corn

68. **wood-roasted = 柴火烘烤的**

69. **fresh-roasted / freshly roasted**

For coffee:

> **freshly roasted** is more idiomatic.

AI. **ROASTED** AS PARTICIPIAL ADJECTIVE

70. **roasted** = cooked/processed by roasting (烤過的 ; 烘焙的)

Examples:

- * roasted meat
- * roasted vegetables
- * roasted coffee
- * roasted nuts

This is the exact grammatical form in your passage.

AJ. **ROASTING** AS NOUN

71. **roasting** = process of cooking by dry heat (烘烤)

> “Roasting brings out the sweetness of the vegetables.”

「**烘烤**能帶出蔬菜的甜味。」

72. **roasting** = coffee-processing stage (咖啡烘焙)

> “Roasting greatly changes the bean's aroma.”

「**烘焙**會大幅改變咖啡豆的香氣。」

73. **roasting** = metallurgical thermal process (焙燒)

> “Roasting removes part of the sulfur.”

「**焙燒**可除去部分硫。」

Same word; completely different industrial context.

AK. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

roast vs bake

Already crucial:

- * roast meat/vegetables
- * bake bread/cakes.

roast vs broil/grill

Roast generally uses surrounding dry heat; grilling/broiling uses more direct intense radiant heat.

roast vs toast

Toast focuses strongly on surface browning; roast commonly develops the food more thoroughly.

roast vs barbecue

barbecue

often involves:

- * live fire/smoke
- * low-and-slow cooking
- * outdoor cooking
- * sauce/style traditions

depending on region.

roast

does not inherently imply smoke or barbecue seasoning.

roast vs sear

sear

rapidly brown the exterior at very high heat.

roast

cook for longer with dry heat.

You can:

> sear first, then roast.

roast vs char

char

blacken/burn the surface.

roast

does not require charring.

roasted vs burnt

roasted

intentionally heated to develop colour/flavour.

burnt

heated excessively until damaged/blackened.

A dark roast coffee is not automatically “burnt,” although people may subjectively describe flavour that way.

roast vs fry

Roasting uses dry heat; frying fundamentally relies on hot fat/oil as the heat-transfer medium.

roast vs ridicule

roast

informal, humorous public/private mocking.

ridicule

general act of making someone look foolish.

Roast can be a form of ridicule.

roast vs scold

roast someone

may mean mock them humorously.

give someone a roasting

can mean scold/criticize them severely.

The noun construction may therefore be much more disciplinary than playful.

roaster — coffee machine vs person

> “We bought a new roaster.”

Could mean:

* machine

> “She's one of the best roasters in the city.”

Likely:

* professional coffee roaster/person.

Context matters.

AL. GRAMMAR

74. **roast + direct object**

- > roast chicken
- > roast coffee beans
- > roast someone online

Same grammar, very different semantic branches.

75. **roast at + temperature**

- > “Roast at 200°C.”

「以 200°C 烘烤。」

76. **roast for + time**

- > “Roast for 45 minutes.”

「烘烤 45 分鐘。」

77. **roast until + condition**

- > “Roast until golden.”

「烤至金黃。」

78. **roast someone for + noun/-ing**

Informal ridicule:

- > “They roasted him for forgetting his lines.”

「他因忘詞而被大家狠狠吐槽。」

79. **be/get roasted**

Can mean:

food

被烘烤

person

被嘲諷 / 狠狠批評

Context decides.

AM. COUNTABILITY

roast — food/dish

Countable:

> a roast

> two roasts

roast — coffee style/level

Countable:

> a light roast

> several different roasts

roast — comedy event

Countable:

> a celebrity roast

> three roasts

roasting — process

Usually uncountable:

> coffee roasting

> ore roasting.

roaster

Countable:

> a coffee roaster

> two industrial roasters.

AN. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning	
-----	-----	
roast — cooking verb	cook using dry surrounding heat	
roast — food noun	roasted meat/dish/cut	
roast — coffee noun	roast degree/style	
roast — ridicule verb	mock someone sharply/humorously	
roast — comedy noun	organized event based on humorous insults	
roast — metallurgy verb	heat ore in reactive atmosphere to cause chemical transformation	
roasted	cooked/processed by roasting; also participial form	
roasting — cooking	process of roasting food/coffee	
roasting — heat slang	extremely hot	
a roasting	severe criticism/scolding	
roasting — metallurgy	ore thermal-treatment process	
roaster — coffee	roasting machine, person, or company	
roaster — industrial	roasting furnace/reactor	
roaster — cooking	appliance/pan or food-classification term	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
-----	-----	
roast food	用乾熱把肉、蔬菜、堅果等烤熟 / 烤香	
roast meat/chicken	烤肉 / 烤雞	
roast vegetables	烤蔬菜	
roast over a fire	放在火上 / 近火處烘烤	

spit-roast	用旋轉烤叉烘烤	
dry-roast	不加入額外油脂進行乾烤	
roast — noun food	烤製的肉類菜式或供烤製的大塊肉	
roast dinner	以烤肉和配菜為主的烤肉餐	
Sunday roast	英式傳統星期日烤肉餐	
pot roast	在鍋中慢煮 / 燜煮的大塊肉類菜式，名稱雖有 roast 但方法近似燉煮	
roasting pan/tin	烤肉 / 蔬菜用烤盤	
roasted coffee	經高溫烘焙、產生咖啡香味與褐變的咖啡豆 / 咖啡	
coffee roasting	把生咖啡豆加熱轉化成可沖煮熟豆的烘焙過程	
roast — coffee	咖啡豆烘焙的程度 / 風格	
light/medium/dark roast	淺焙 / 中焙 / 深焙	
roast level/degree	咖啡烘焙程度	
roast profile	咖啡烘焙過程的時間、溫度、熱量等控制曲線 / 設定	
roast date	咖啡豆實際烘焙日期	
coffee roaster — machine	咖啡烘焙機	
coffee roaster — person/company	咖啡烘焙師 / 烘焙公司	
roast someone	非正式：狠狠取笑、吐槽、嘲諷某人	
get roasted	被眾人狠狠嘲笑 / 吐槽	
a roast — comedy	以公開幽默嘲諷某人為主的吐槽活動	
celebrity roast	名人吐槽大會	
roast battle	以互相嘲諷笑話比拼的吐槽對決	
roasting — temperature	非正式：非常炎熱；熱得要命	
a roasting	非正式：一頓猛烈批評 / 責罵	
give someone a roasting	狠狠責罵 / 批評某人	
roast ore	在空氣 / 反應氣氛中高溫加熱礦石以改變其化學形態；焙燒	
ore roasting	冶金中的礦石焙燒	
sulfide roasting	硫化礦的焙燒處理	
roaster — metallurgy	用於礦石焙燒的爐 / 反應器	
roasted — adjective	經烘烤 / 焙燒處理過的	
roasting — process noun	烘烤、咖啡烘焙或礦石焙燒的過程	

For your original sentence

> “Your letter has the smell of ****roasted coffee****...”

The exact meaning is:

> ****roasted = coffee beans have already undergone the heat-processing stage that creates the familiar brown colour, aroma, and flavour associated with brewed coffee.****

So the phrase evokes:

> ****fresh coffee beans being roasted / freshly roasted coffee****

and helps make Kam Chai's café ambition feel almost physically present.

There is a nice stylistic chain:

> **roasted coffee**
> → smell
> → café
> → dream
> → future business.

For the core database, I would keep **5 major semantic branches**:

1. **cook food using dry heat**
2. **noun: roasted food / roast dish**
3. **coffee: roasting process and roast degree/style**
4. **informal: mock, ridicule, or severely criticize someone**
5. **metallurgy: thermally treat ore in a reactive atmosphere**

Then explicitly index **roasted, roasting, roaster, light/medium/dark roast, roast profile, Sunday roast, pot roast, celebrity roast, get roasted, a roasting, ore roasting**, because these have become established enough that a single gloss like 「烤」 would miss substantial modern usage.